5 Backups and your data

QUICK

13. Backups, restoring, and folder names

Quick version

No time to read it all? This is the short version. The full guide is below.

- Every backup is one `.tar` file in the `backups/` folder. Its name tells you the date, the time and the label.
- Backups run by themselves: every hour the garden looks at what changed, and backs up more often when it is busy, less when it is quiet, at least once a week. Backups you make yourself are never deleted for you.
- Each backup includes all your photos (about 800 MB). Automatic ones are thinned (today's newest 3, then one a day for a week), so they need about 8 GB at most.
- Make one: menu `6`, then `1`. Check one: `bash garden.sh verify`. Restore one: menu `7` (it first saves a `before-restore` backup).
- Keep 3 copies: on the garden computer, on your NAS (menu `6`, then `4`) and on Google Drive (menu `6`, then `5`). A second NAS or a PC's shared folder can get every backup too (menu `6`, then `13`; up to 3 network places).
- A Windows PC can collect a copy every week, into a folder you pick: Windows menu, `M`, then `13`.
- A backup on the same laptop does not protect you from a broken laptop. Copy one to a USB stick now and then.
- To rename or move a file or folder (photos, pages, backups and so on), use menu `M`, then `18` (or menu `8`, then `8`). Every place that uses it changes with it: guide 26.

> - Do not rename the folders inside your photos folder, or photo files, by hand: use that menu, so the website and the database follow.